

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, identity and trust infrastructure.*

Positioning, fintech founder turned platform PM: I have shipped from zero-to-one, led cross-functional teams of 15+, and rebuilt broken delivery organisations.

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§ WHY CLERA

Identity and trust infrastructure is the layer that makes fintech products possible at all: get it wrong and every downstream feature is compromised. The posting's emphasis on "second-order effects" within a larger product ecosystem is exactly the problem I find most interesting, it is where systems thinking either pays off or falls apart. Clera is seed-stage, which means the roadmap is still plastic enough that deliberate architectural choices will compound over years.

That is the kind of leverage that a late-stage PM role rarely offers.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo prototyping and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding assistance
- **Cursor**, LLM-assisted refactors in VSCode
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy interface work
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, document drafting
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing narrative decks

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built alone from zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both firms and workers until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents running the funnel so one person operates the day-to-day.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; full build executed with Claude Code and Lovable.
 - Demonstrates the end-to-end founder discipline Clera needs at seed stage: discovery, architecture, build, and operate.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CLERA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow customer calls and engineering stand-ups, map the existing product surface against stated customer problems, and write down every assumption I cannot yet verify, the list becomes the discovery backlog.

WEEK 2

Slice and sequence.

Take the highest-uncertainty items from that list, propose the cheapest experiment that resolves each one, and align with engineering on what the roadmap's next horizon actually requires technically before any commitment is made.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive the first initiative from spec to production, instrument it against agreed success metrics, and report clearly on what happened, so the whole distributed team learns from the same evidence rather than from competing interpretations.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Clera team,

Identity and trust infrastructure is a product category where the consequences of a wrong decision propagate silently for months before they surface as customer churn or regulatory friction. That is precisely why it attracts me. I have spent the last five years as a product manager in environments where getting the foundations right was not optional: a national labour-market analytics platform at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit where I was also deputy IT security officer, a B2B SaaS platform for insurers and reinsurers at EMIL Group, and a defence AI data platform for the FCAS European programme at Rohde & Schwarz. Across all three I owned the roadmap end-to-end, worked directly with engineering on architecture trade-offs, and held accountability for both delivery velocity and long-term product quality.

The posting asks for someone who can reason about how individual features interact within a larger product ecosystem and anticipate second-order effects. I recognise that language because it describes the failure mode I have spent the most time correcting. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing workflows, one UI-led, one developer-code-first, and the elegant UI one recorded exactly zero clicks. Redirecting strategy based on that finding increased pipeline runs by 200% and avoided months of wasted engineering. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver, cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. Scope discipline and systems thinking are the same skill.

Beyond employed roles, I have direct fintech and payments experience as a founder. Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile group-based P2P payments product I built from zero, was acquired and is operated inside the girocard ecosystem by Sparkasse. I understand B2B platform dynamics from the identity layer upward: at Bundesdruckerei I worked on data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes, and at Qcrypt AG I co-founded and owned the product architecture for quantum-secure encryption targeting enterprise buyers. That combination, fintech founder, identity and security domain, B2B platform PM, maps closely onto what Clera is building.

I work fully remote, am based in Berlin, and operate entirely within EU timezones. I communicate in writing the way this posting describes: decisions documented, assumptions

explicit, reasoning transparent, so distributed teams stay aligned without synchronous overhead. I would be glad to talk about what the next twelve months of the roadmap look like and what you think the hardest product problem is right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of ownership in regulated B2B and platform environments, fintech, insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare. I turn strategy and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap, lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery, and keep distributed teams aligned through clear written communication. As a fintech founder I have also taken products from zero to acquisition, which means I understand the platform layer from both the builder and the operator side.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

B2B and Platform: B2B SaaS, two-sided marketplace design, payments flow and PSP integration, identity management, fintech regulatory context, GDPR/DSGVO.

Agile Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, WIP limits, GitOps rollout, ArgoCD, CI/CD, containerised environments, same-day hotfix paths.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists. GitOps rollout with ArgoCD reduced deployment time from days to 30 minutes; developer-code-first strategy increased pipeline runs by 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market platform. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving 75% of time per data update. Full bare-metal-to-containers migration. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition dropped to a single departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut insurance product launch time from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY SITE IT MODERNISATION 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero to one alone: two-sided B2B marketplace, anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Enterprise security hardware and software. Three-layer product installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments product built from zero, acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · CLERA

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